

Manoel Island: back to the public?

The return from MIDI, and the promise of a national park, tested against public records

THE CLAIM

“We are transforming this area into a national park designed according to the wishes of the Maltese and Gozitan people.”

Prime Minister Robert Abela, 13 May 2026 (as reported by Newsbook)

Said on the day the deed ending MIDI's concession was signed.

The deed and the Prime Minister's own release were not readable by us; we used MIDI's announcements and news reports.

VERDICT

SUPPORTED

*The return is confirmed;
“national park” is Not measurable.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

13 May

Public deed signed

MIDI's own announcement: concession over Manoel Island and Fort Tigné ended, “resulting in the return thereof to Government”.

57 days

From first announcement to deed

17 March to 13 May 2026, after Parliament and MIDI's shareholders approved.

€43m

Net cost (not part of the claim)

MIDI: €47.3m gross, “circa” €43m net of VAT; 55% of the €78m MIDI asked for.

0 of 6

Acts that define a “national park”

The term is absent from six Maltese Acts we searched. No plan, designation or date found.

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Padel courts sanctioned or approved

Planning Authority, 16 July 2026, on the island's former football ground (Lovin Malta). Pledge label: Not measurable (9 Oct 2026).

FAIR TO SAY

The return is real and documented. The Government has announced a local plan change and a management plan; we could not find them yet.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The deed and the shareholder circular.

☐ What “national park” means in law here.

☐ The local plan amendment, if made.

☐ Heritage Malta's management plan.